Earth and Planets · Knowledge Organiser

Learning goal: I can describe the Sun, Earth, and Moon as spheres and explain what orbits what in our solar system.

Today I Can

I can state that the Sun, Earth, and Moon are approximately spherical bodies.

I can order the eight planets from the Sun and distinguish rocky planets from gas/ice giants.

I can explain that planets orbit the Sun while the Moon orbits the Earth.

Must-Know Words

sphere: a round 3D ball shape, like the Sun, Earth, and Moon

orbit: the curved path one object in space takes around another because of gravity

solar system: the Sun and the eight planets (plus moons and rocks) that orbit it

star: a giant ball of hot glowing gas that makes its own light, like our Sun

Core Science Steps

First, the Sun is a star at the centre of the solar system, not a planet.

Second, the four inner planets (Mercury, Venus, Earth, Mars) are smaller and have rocky surfaces.

Third, the four outer planets (Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, Neptune) are much larger gas and ice giants.

Keep the Science Clear

Combine two pieces of evidence when explaining why we know Earth is approximately spherical.

Classroom wall charts draw planets close together so they fit on the page; real space is mostly empty distance.